FocusQuest Ethical Reflection

Who could be excluded?

FocusQuest requires a suitable device and reliable internet access. Students without these resources may not be able to use file analysis, generated questions, or external video searches. The first version also assumes that the learner understands English, can read digital study materials, and knows how to upload a file or paste text. Students who rely on screen readers, keyboard navigation, captions, reduced motion, or high-contrast settings could be excluded if we do not test those features properly.

The app is designed with university students in mind, so its language and examples may not suit younger learners. It may also be less useful for practical subjects that depend on laboratory work, physical practice, or specialist software.

What does the app assume about its learner?

The design assumes that learners already have appropriate course material and can decide whether an AI suggestion fits their assignment. It also assumes that shorter focus sessions, an adventure map, and structured breaks will feel motivating. ADHD affects people differently, so these choices will not help everyone.

The app does not diagnose ADHD or claim to treat it. A learner does not need a diagnosis to use the product, and the app should never present ordinary procrastination as proof of a medical condition.

Privacy and uploaded materials

Study files may contain names, student numbers, teacher materials, unpublished research, or copyrighted content. Learners should receive a clear explanation of what happens to an uploaded file before processing begins. The app should collect only the material needed for the selected function, avoid permanent storage where possible, and never expose API keys in the browser. Users should not upload confidential information unless the product can provide appropriate protection.

Possible misuse and negative effects

Schools or employers could misuse FocusQuest to monitor productivity, compare students, or pressure learners to work for longer periods. Institutions should not use FocusQuest activity as evidence of effort, ability, attendance, or disability.

Remaining limitations

This hackathon prototype cannot prove that FocusQuest improves learning or reduces procrastination. Meaningful evaluation would require voluntary testing with a diverse group of students, including students with ADHD, followed by changes based on their feedback. Until then, we describe FocusQuest as an educational support tool and remain transparent about its limits.